

Sound Buy

 I am planning to buy a PMP which has voice recording and FM radio. I wish to purchase Apple's iPod Touch but I am unable to get my hands on it. My budget is Rs 13,000.

Anirudh Jain

 Firstly, Apple's iPod Touch doesn't have support for FM Radio or voice recording. If you want a touchscreen with the functions you've mentioned, I suggest the Cowon D2. It's not as flashy and doesn't have as big a screen, but what it does have is terrific performance, with unmatched features. At under Rs 10,000 for the 4 GB version, the D2 is your best bet. It's also expandable.

Phone Call

 I am looking for a cellphone, and these are my needs: Net browser XHTML / HTML, 3G, Screen (320x240), FM radio (stereo), fast processor (200 MHz or more), video player, 2 MP camera. My budget is Rs 14,000.

Arnav Sengupta

 I suggest you take a serious look at Nokia's N73 Music Edition. At Rs 14,000, it will give you strong multimedia capabilities with a 3.2 MP camera, good music playback, and 2 GB of storage via MiniSD that is bundled with the phone. 3G browsing is a sad misnomer in India, and the browsing speed will be bottlenecked by your service provider and not your GSM handset, so I suggest you forget about this feature—it's useless for now.

Plug And Play

 I want to buy a pair of earphones for around Rs 1,500 for my Sony Walkman. I would prefer Sony earphones but others will also do. I have a Sony NW-E003F Walkman.

Nikhil Sonthaliya

 For in-ear type earplugs I usually suggest Creative's EP630. These earplugs have become very common and at Rs 900 they offer terrific value for money. I've used them myself and must say that for the price, the performance you get is pretty good. Beware of duplicates though—their popularity has spawned counterfeit look-alikes. Please insist on a bill when you do purchase them.

Board Games

 I'd like to purchase a motherboard. But I am confused whether to go for an Intel- or NVIDIA-based motherboard. My basic need is a good onboard graphic support. I'd also like to know about the performance and onboard graphics of the chipset designed by Abit.

Jidnesh Chaudhari

 Abit is a motherboard vendor like ASUS, MSI, Gigabyte, Foxconn, etc. They do not manufacture onboard graphics chipsets. Since

you mentioned Intel, I take it you are going for a system based on an Intel Core 2 Duo processor. In that case, NVIDIA has better graphics solutions than Intel or AMD. The new GeForce 7050 is a good onboard solution. I recommend MSI's P6NGM based on their GeForce 7050 chipset. It's priced at Rs 4,800. I suggest you also look at 2 GB of system memory since the onboard solution will hog some main memory for video purposes.

Top Choice

 I need a laptop with the following uses and parameters in mind: basic office work, watching movies, music, browsing, basic gaming. My budget is Rs 50,000. I want a minimum of 1 GB RAM and a 160 GB HDD, webcam and DVD writer. Lastly, is it safe to buy a laptop in SP Road, Bangalore?

Ashwin S

 Your best bet seems to be Dell, and considering that all Dell laptops ship from Bangalore you're well covered if you're in the city. Dell also has a very cool five-year warranty. Regarding your preference, you haven't mentioned the size of screen you want or the processor. I am assuming a 15.4-inch screen. I'm also going by the assumption that you'll stick to Windows Vista, and opt for 2 GB of memory in lieu of 1 GB. The Dell Inspiron 1525 comes to Rs 38,000 with a 2.0 GHz Core 2 Duo processor and 2 GB of RAM. If you want to spend more on something faster and more slick looking, the Dell XPS 1530 will come to Rs 52,000 with the same processor and a 128 MB GeForce 8400GS graphics card that will handle casual gaming easily. Both laptops come with DVD writers and 2 MP webcams, so all your needs are covered.

Right Mix

 I'm upgrading my PC with a Quad-Core processor, Gigabyte GA-P35-D53R motherboard, 2 GB RAM, a Palit 8800GT card. I'm confused about QX6700 and Q6600 processors, which one is better? Which is better—the quad core 'QX' or 'Q'? And ultimately the power supply—is 550 watts sufficient? Please give the prices also. You can change my configuration if you feel something better is available.

Zubair Mustahid

 The QX6700 (2.66 GHz) is an *Extreme Edition* and while it is a faster processor it's also insanely expensive. The newer Q6600 (2.4 GHz) is also available and it's also reasonably overclockable. A 550 W power supply from CoolerMaster or Antec should suffice, but I recommend a little more juice just to be on the safer side, especially if you plan on more than one HDD. Look for CoolerMasters eXtreme Power 650W or Antecs Trio 650 watts. Go for 800 MHz DDR2. For the motherboard, I recommend the Abit IP35-E, for Rs 7,500—superb value for money. Your choice of graphics card is good—stick to it. ■

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